Borislav S. Sabotinov

Engineering Leader · Platform & HPC · Applied AI
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ENGINEERING LEADERSHIP PROFILE

Staff-level engineering leader who builds platforms, and the teams and standards behind them, that take real cost out of engineering work. Grew an internal HPC platform from a side project to a production system serving 1,500+ engineers across four global regions, returning $12M+ annually in reclaimed time. Lead through influence: the architecture I authored is now the company-standard pattern other IT teams reuse, cutting their delivery time from five months to under three weeks. I measure success by the engineers in front of and behind the platform, the users it serves and the team that maintains it. U.S. Army veteran.

EXPERIENCE

General Motors

Jan. 2014 – Present

Staff Software Engineer (Lead), HPC Innovation 2019 – Present

- **Built and scaled a platform org's flagship product**, the HPC Toolkit, a Slack/Teams-native control plane for high-performance compute from a personal side project to a production system serving 1,500+ CAE engineers across four global regions, processing ~4M simulations/year and returning $12M+ annually in reclaimed engineering time.
- **Established the company-wide architectural standard** for conversational platforms: the reusable Azure Bot Service pattern I authored cut new bot delivery from four months to two weeks and is now independently reused by multiple IT teams - organizational leverage well beyond my own team.
- **Lead the next-generation AI orchestration initiative**, integrating graph-backed reasoning (Neo4j) and a multi-agent orchestration layer over HPC workflows, on a roadmap to $35M+/year in value. Set technical direction across teams and ran a four-vendor graph-database evaluation to anchor the decision.
- **Drove cross-team platform convergence** by publishing a single Kubernetes-to-OpenShift deployment standard (Kustomize base + overlays) and coaching 6+ application teams through migration, replacing brittle one-off pipelines and reducing portfolio-wide tech debt.
- **Set delivery standards and quality gates** adopted across the portfolio: consolidated 72 Jenkins jobs into 4 version-controlled pipelines, led the Jenkins Enterprise to Jenkins OSS migration for containerized builds, and introduced automated Fortify scanning for C/C++.
- **Improved platform throughput and reliability**: 70%+ faster CI builds via Kubernetes persistent-volume caching for Maven artifacts; 4x Artifactory capacity by driving the cross-org quota increase that was blocking build and deployment throughput.
- **Developed engineers and raised the bar around me**: mentored interns and early-career engineers (e.g., shipping a Python Sonar API reporting tool), stood up an internal Slack community for graph/AI experimentation, and treated documentation and reusable patterns as part of shipping.
- **Owned high-stakes release execution**, enabling 12+ major production releases annually in a vehicle-design software environment with complex distributed dependencies.

Software Engineer, Computer-Aided Engineering (CAE) 2016 – 2019

- **Prevented hundreds of failed HPC jobs** by re-architecting a Java CLI for HPC job submission, delivered ahead of schedule.
- **Cut 3K lines of Java and remediated security vulnerabilities** in one month against a six-month plan, while extending a Classic ASP/IIS web app during an infrastructure migration without breaking compliance.
- **Saved 5+ hours of runtime per job** for Maxwell electromagnetic applications and resolved hung jobs by partnering with vendors on integration-code upgrades.

Software Engineer, Customer Care & Aftersales / Manufacturing IT 2014 – 2016

- **Cut $200K+ in annual cost** by replacing external contractors and building an IBM DataStage ETL framework in-house; consolidated 12 disparate databases during a IBM DB2 to Oracle migration.
- **Led UI development** (AngularJS, Spring MVC) for a workflow app used across 100+ global assembly-plant floors.

SPEAKING, WRITING & PUBLICATIONS

- **Speaker, Texas Linux Fest 2026**, "From Log Files to Live Signals: Rethinking HPC Operations on Linux Bare Metal."
- **Speaker, DevOpsDays Austin 2026**, “Value All the Way Down: Applying DevOps Where CI/CD Assumptions Break.”
- **Technical writer, bss8.dev (monthly)**. Recent essays include “Chat Is Where the Work Is” and “Repositories Define, CI Executes.”

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

M.S., Computer Science, Texas State University (3.92 GPA) Dec. 2021
B.S., Public Affairs, Indiana University (3.94 GPA, highest distinction) May 2013
GM OnRamp Leader Essentials (8-week leadership development program) 2026

Certifications: Azure DevOps Engineer Expert, Azure Developer Associate, Azure Fundamentals, SAFe 5 Practitioner, Certified Jenkins Engineer.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Leadership & Practice: Platform engineering, internal developer platforms, technical strategy, cross-team standards, mentorship, Agile/SAFe, DevOps.
Languages: Go, Python, Java, SQL, JavaScript, Bash, C/C++.
Platforms & Infra: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Kustomize, Helm, Docker, Azure, Azure Bot Service, Databricks, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Terraform, RabbitMQ, event-driven services, CI/CD.
Data & AI: Neo4j, PostgreSQL, Oracle, IBM DB2, Firestore; multi-agent orchestration, RAG pipelines.

MILITARY SERVICE

Military Police (31B), U.S. Army — prior Secret clearance (eligible for reinstatement) Aug. 2008 – Aug. 2016

- **Army Commendation Medal** for service in Afghanistan (Operations Enduring Freedom and New Dawn); supported intelligence operations in a Forward Tactical Operations Center.